WEAPONISING THE PAGER: HOW IT UNFOLDED

The operation that booby-trapped and detonated pagers and walkie-talkies in Lebanon involved a complex supply-chain subversion and technical finesse. Israel's Mossad and Shin Bet agencies are presumed to be behind it

Graphic by **NILANJAN DAS**

1

In February 2024, Hezbollah chief Hassan Nasrallah asks operatives to stop using mobile phones which could be tracked; they turn to low-tech pagers/ walkie talkies; around 5,000 were bought in the past months



2



The AR-924 pager model was a product from Taiwanese manufacturer Gold Apollo, which said it was produced and sold under licence by the Hungary-based firm BAC

3



Israeli spy agency Mossad allegedly intercepted the pagers through a supply chain interdiction. It is also possible that BAC Consulting is a shell company set up by Mossad



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They were then sent along to Lebanon, ready to be detonated by sending electronic messages

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The next day, walkie-talkies used by the Hezbollah exploded in a similar fashion, killing over 20

Production of the IC-V82 model walkie-talkies, made by Japanese firm ICOM, had stopped a decade ago. The devices that blew up were likely counterfeits

